500KM PEDAL POWER 2024



AFRICAN VISION MALAWI

'Creating Lasting Change'

www.africanvision.org.uk

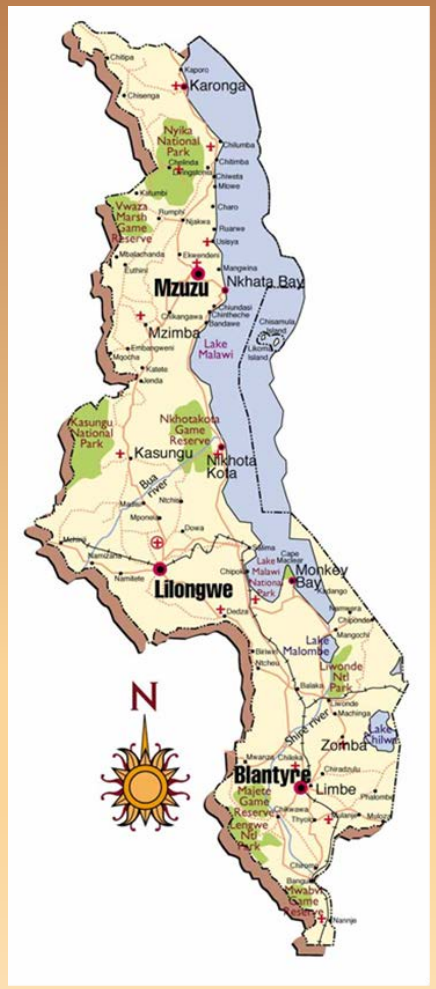


MALAWI

Landlocked country with 20 million population. Capital city is Lilongwe.



Malawi





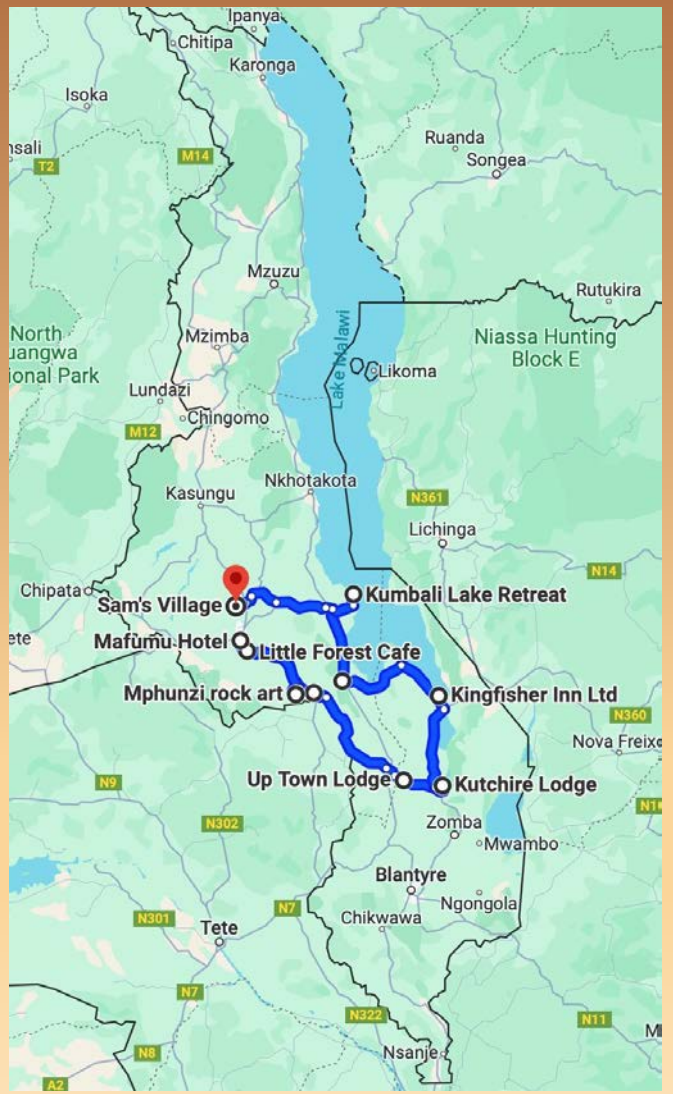
A TRIP OF A LIFETIME, THAT IS LIFE CHANGING TO YOU AND OTHERS!

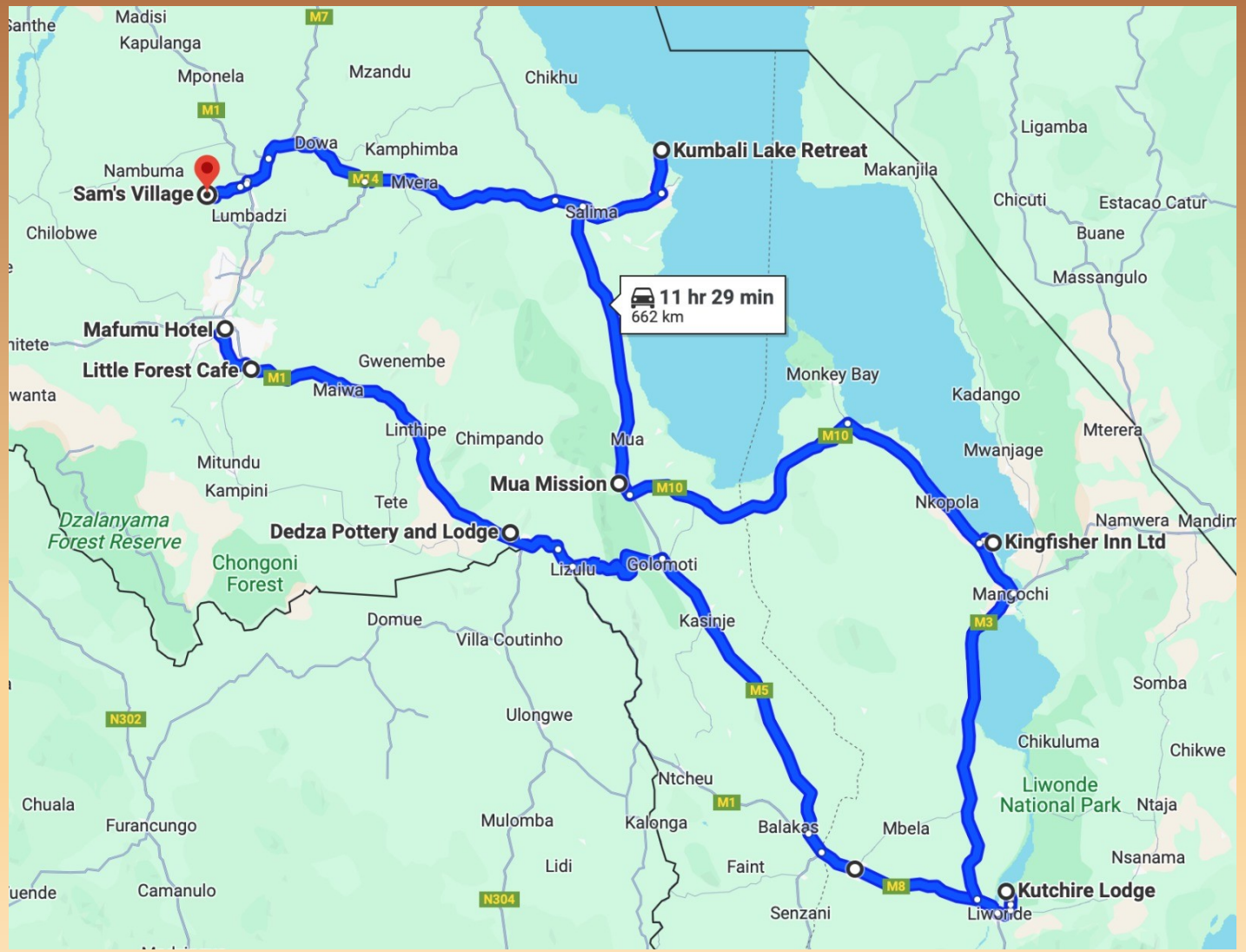


African Vision Malawi has been going for 18 years. Malawi is the poorest, non-war country in the world! 85% are subsistent farmers. Our programmes aim to see people become self-sufficient by providing vocational and life skills training. You will see beautiful parts of Malawi, the changing landscapes and experience the 'warm heart of Africa' through meeting local people. This trip is an experience and not a race!



THE CYCLE JOURNEY







DATES

Friday 10th May – Arrive Malawi

Saturday 11th May – Start cycling from Lilongwe to Dedza

Sunday 12th May – Cycle from Dedza to Balaka via Golomoti Road

Monday 13th May – Cycle to Liwonde National Park and do a safari

Tuesday 14th May – Transfer to Mangochi for day of rest!

Wednesday 15th May – Cycle from Mangochi to Mua Mission

Thursday 16th May – Cycle from Mua Mission to Senga Bay

Friday 17th May – Rest day at Kumbali Lake Retreat

Saturday 18th May – Final cycle day from Kumbali to Sam's Village. Celebration!

Sunday 19th May – See some programmes.

Monday 20th May – See some programmes and final evening together with cultural entertainment!

Tuesday 21st May – Depart or stay on to volunteer or travel around Malawi



ARRIVAL DAY – FRIDAY 10TH MAY









Arrive in Malawi between 12 and 1pm. Get fitted on your bikes at Land & Lakes and then rest at Mafumu Hotel in Lilongwe



DAY ONE – SATURDAY 11TH MAY (65KM 650M ASCENT)









Transfer through Lilongwe to avoid the traffic, then cycle on partially hilly roads to the Cave Paintings at Dedza (the highest town in Malawi). Rest at Dedza Pottery Lodge by Dedza mountain.



DAY TWO – SUNDAY 12TH MAY (130KM – 540M ASCENT AND 1,440M DECENT)







Exciting cycle down 30km on the Golomoti Road! Stop to view the carving stalls, then straight on to Balaka to dive into the pool!



DAY THREE – MONDAY 13TH MAY (40KM)









A short ride to make up for the long one yesterday! Balaka to Liwonde National Park with the final 6km on dirt. Time for lunch, then relax before you chose to do a land or water safari.





DAY FOUR – TUESDAY 15TH MAY (REST DAY)







I would highly recommend doing another morning safari for an extra $50. Then after a late breakfast, pack your things and we transfer 96km to the Kingfisher Inn which will take 1.45hr. Lunch, dinner and rest time by the beautiful Lake Malawi.



DAY FIVE – WEDNESDAY 16TH MAY (100KM)







Today you hop back on your bike and head towards Mua Mission, which has a cultural centre where you can learn about Malawi and the local cultural tribes. The road is pretty flat up to the final 10km which is on dirt.



DAY SIX – THURSDAY 17TH MAY (90KM)







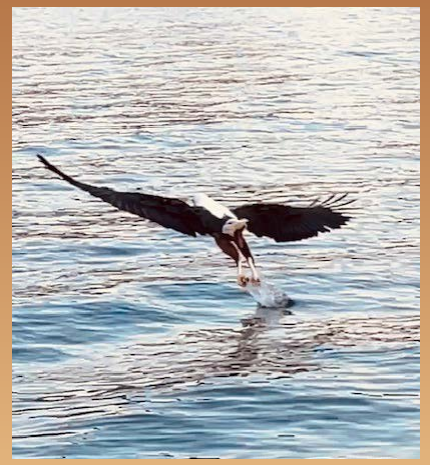


Heading north on the Lakeshore road, you pass an enormous Baobab tree which is at least 2000 years old! After a stop for an ice cream at Salima we have the final 30km ending on dirt to the beautiful Kumbali Lake Retreat.



DAY SEVEN – FRIDAY 18TH MAY (DAY OF REST)



Kumbali Lake Retreat is set in a quiet national reserve, with beautiful birds and you may see baboons around. Your choice to rest, hike, visit the local village and feed the Fish Eagles, finishing with a sunset dip in the lake.






DAY EIGHT – SATURDAY 19TH MAY
60KM (390M ASCENT AND 425M DESCENT)









Your last cycle day! You will cycle with a stop at a craft market for 30 mins while the bikes get put on the truck. You will then transfer and get back on your bikes just after Mvera with a fantastic 5km downward cycle, but then there are ups and downs before you get to the dirt turn off heading towards Sam's Village. Arrive to a celebration of local musicians and a well deserved drink!



DAYS 9 & 10 SUN & MON 20TH & 21ST MAY – VISIT AVM PROGRAMMES









After your celebration meal last night and a later breakfast than other days, you will be shown around some of our programmes where we support vulnerable people and empower them to become self-sufficient. You will see where your well raised funds go!



THINGS YOU MIGHT LIKE TO KNOW

Bikes will be hired, but you can take your own if you wish.

Keep yourselves safe and bring helmet, water bottle and anything that makes you comfortable. We will give you a list of things to bring.

Weather is generally around 15 in the early hours rising to 25-27 degrees. No rain!

Cycle costs £1,650 which covers in country transport, back-up, accommodation, food, safari and bike hire. You can pay in instalments. Cost doesn't include flights, insurance and visa is free if under 30 days stay. $50 if staying longer.

Malawi has malaria so you need antimalarials

We will organise some local training rides in UK

